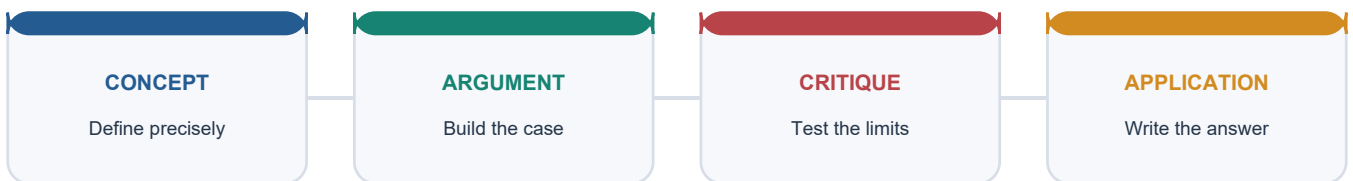


SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

Sovereignty and Pluralism - Solved Practice Workbook

Solved practice workbook: 32 original MCQs with option-specific explanations, verified PYQ status and six original GS Mains models.

LEARNING PATH



Deterministic fallback visual: move from precise concepts through argument and critique to exam application.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

CONTENTS / WORKBOOK INDEX

Major learning parts and meaningful subtopics are listed in document order. Page numbers are generated from the final PDF layout; PDF bookmarks mirror the same hierarchy.

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Sovereignty and Pluralism - Solved Practice Workbook

Subject: Political Theory **Target stages:** UPSC Prelims and General Studies Mains only **Primary ownership:** GS-II conceptual foundations **Approval:** pending explicit user approval

WORKBOOK GUIDE

- Attempt Questions 1-24 as hard core diagnostics and Questions 25-32 as remedial traps.
- Record the reason for eliminating each wrong option before reading the four option-specific explanations.
- The key is a fixed A -> B -> C -> D rotation; cover it while attempting, because the rotation is a production standard and must never replace elimination reasoning.
- For Mains, write within the stated GS ceiling: 150 words for 10 marks and 250 words for 15 marks.
- No direct owned Topic 11 Prelims/GS Mains PYQ is verified; no question owned by another UPSC paper is imported or relabelled.
- The generic 20-mark optional-style model is N/A here: Political Theory is a UPSC Prelims and General Studies Mains foundation, not an optional paper.

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

Practice design

- Questions 1-24 are hard core GS/Prelims diagnostics; Questions 25-32 are remedial close-option repairs.
- Formats are deliberately varied: definition control, multi-statement, sequence, matching, chronology, elimination, application, evidence and inference.
- The correct option rotates strictly A -> B -> C -> D, repeated eight times across the 32 questions, giving 8 A, 8 B, 8 C and 8 D.
- Because the key is a fixed rotation it carries no diagnostic value: options are matched for register and length, so an answer can only be reached by reasoning about content.
- Each of the 128 options carries its own question-specific explanation and each question closes with a distinct examiner trap.

MCQ 1

Which proposition is correctly associated with **Sovereignty**?

- A. supreme legal authority of the state; the power to issue binding laws, commands and decisions within jurisdiction.
- B. the view that important associations in society embody values and claims not wholly created by the state, so the state cannot be treated as morally all-comprehensive (PDF pp.196-198).
- C. Gauba resolves the federalism puzzle by distinguishing sovereignty, which remains single, from powers, which may be distributed among organs and levels of government (PDF pp.186-187).
- D. legal sovereignty is the formal law-making superior; political sovereignty is the effective power behind it; popular sovereignty places ultimate authority in the people (PDF pp.189-193).

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A States the source-recorded proposition for Sovereignty.
- **B:** B Attaches to Pluralism, not Sovereignty.
- **C:** C Attaches to Sovereignty vs power, not Sovereignty.
- **D:** D Attaches to Legal vs political vs popular sovereignty, not Sovereignty.

Examiner trap: Do not identify Sovereignty by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic.

MCQ 2

Which proposition is correctly associated with **Legal sovereignty**?

- A. sovereignty is legally unbound but morally limited, and resistance may sometimes be justified if utility is violated (PDF p.183).
- B. Definite, organized and sanction-backed authority recognized by law; closest to Austin's formulation (PDF pp.183-190).
- C. The effective power behind the legal sovereign; Dicey's "other sovereign" to which formal authority must bow (PDF pp.189-190).
- D. The people in corporate capacity are the source of authority; government is their agent, not the sovereign itself (PDF pp.182-193).

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Attaches to Bentham, not Legal sovereignty.
- **B:** B States the source-recorded proposition for Legal sovereignty.
- **C:** C Attaches to Political sovereignty, not Legal sovereignty.
- **D:** D Attaches to Popular sovereignty, not Legal sovereignty.

Examiner trap: Do not identify Legal sovereignty by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic.

MCQ 3

Which proposition is correctly associated with **Political sovereignty**?

- A. sovereignty is legally unbound but morally limited, and resistance may sometimes be justified if utility is violated (PDF p.183).
- B. The people in corporate capacity are the source of authority; government is their agent, not the sovereign itself (PDF pp.182-193).
- C. The effective power behind the legal sovereign; Dicey's "other sovereign" to which formal authority must bow (PDF pp.189-190).
- D. de jure refers to legal title; de facto refers to actual effective control, especially in revolutionary situations (PDF pp.187-188).

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Attaches to Bentham, not Political sovereignty.
- **B:** B Attaches to Popular sovereignty, not Political sovereignty.
- **C:** C States the source-recorded proposition for Political sovereignty.
- **D:** D Attaches to De jure vs de facto sovereignty, not Political sovereignty.

Examiner trap: Do not identify Political sovereignty by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic.

MCQ 4

Which proposition is correctly associated with **Popular sovereignty**?

- A. sovereignty is legally unbound but morally limited, and resistance may sometimes be justified if utility is violated (PDF p.183).
- B. de jure refers to legal title; de facto refers to actual effective control, especially in revolutionary situations (PDF pp.187-188).
- C. The effective power behind the legal sovereign; Dicey's "other sovereign" to which formal authority must bow (PDF pp.189-190).
- D. The people in corporate capacity are the source of authority; government is their agent, not the sovereign itself (PDF pp.182-193).

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Attaches to Bentham, not Popular sovereignty.
- **B:** B Attaches to De jure vs de facto sovereignty, not Popular sovereignty.
- **C:** C Attaches to Political sovereignty, not Popular sovereignty.
- **D:** D States the source-recorded proposition for Popular sovereignty.

Examiner trap: Do not identify Popular sovereignty by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic.

MCQ 5

Which proposition is correctly associated with **Pluralism**?

- A. the view that important associations in society embody values and claims not wholly created by the state, so the state cannot be treated as morally all-.
- B. Gauba resolves the federalism puzzle by distinguishing sovereignty, which remains single, from powers, which may be distributed among organs and levels of.
- C. supreme legal authority of the state; the power to issue binding laws, commands and decisions within jurisdiction.
- D. legal sovereignty is the formal law-making superior; political sovereignty is the effective power behind it; popular sovereignty places ultimate authority in.

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A States the source-recorded proposition for Pluralism.
- **B:** B Attaches to Sovereignty vs power, not Pluralism.
- **C:** C Attaches to Sovereignty, not Pluralism.
- **D:** D Attaches to Legal vs political vs popular sovereignty, not Pluralism.

Examiner trap: Do not identify Pluralism by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic.

MCQ 6

Which proposition is correctly associated with **Monistic sovereignty**?

- A. sovereignty is absolute and perpetual; the sovereign is source of law, though not freed from duty or moral responsibility altogether (PDF p.181).
- B. the classical view from Bodin to Austin that sovereignty is one, supreme, indivisible and located in a definite person or body (PDF pp.194-195).
- C. the people themselves are sovereign through the general will; government is only an agent and cannot logically claim sovereignty (PDF pp.182-193).
- D. pluralists do not deny that the state has compulsory jurisdiction; they deny that this legal superiority automatically proves total moral superiority.

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Attaches to Bodin, not Monistic sovereignty.
- **B:** B States the source-recorded proposition for Monistic sovereignty.
- **C:** C Attaches to Rousseau, not Monistic sovereignty.
- **D:** D Attaches to State vs association, not Monistic sovereignty.

Examiner trap: Do not identify Monistic sovereignty by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic.

MCQ 7

Which proposition is correctly associated with **The five classical characteristics of sovereignty**?

- A. MacIver concludes that the state should coordinate and resolve conflicts between associations rather than determine their purposes.
- B. This maxim is not traceable to Gauba or to the Socio-Political Philosophy Kautilya synopsis used here; it is more reliably associated with Lord Palmerston..
- C. These five attributes should be read as the classical/Austinian doctrine taken together, not as isolated claims unique to one thinker - Bodin supplies.
- D. internal sovereignty means supremacy over persons and associations inside the territory; external sovereignty means independence from foreign control in.

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Attaches to MacIver, not The five classical characteristics of sovereignty.
- **B:** B Attaches to "Kautilya said states have no permanent friends or enemies.", not The five classical characteristics of sovereignty.
- **C:** C States the source-recorded proposition for The five classical characteristics of sovereignty.
- **D:** D Attaches to Internal vs external sovereignty, not The five classical characteristics of sovereignty.

Examiner trap: Do not identify The five classical characteristics of sovereignty by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic.

MCQ 8

Which proposition is correctly associated with **State vs government**?

- A. the people themselves are sovereign through the general will; government is only an agent and cannot logically claim sovereignty (PDF pp.182-193).
- B. pluralists do not deny that the state has compulsory jurisdiction; they deny that this legal superiority automatically proves total moral superiority.
- C. about half a century after Bodin, Grotius extended sovereignty into the external/international sphere - independence of the sovereign state from foreign control.
- D. sovereignty belongs to the state as an abstract continuing entity; governments are changing agents that exercise assigned powers (PDF pp.185-187, 202-203).

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Attaches to Rousseau, not State vs government.
- **B:** B Attaches to State vs association, not State vs government.
- **C:** C Attaches to Grotius (Dutch jurist, "father of international law"), not State vs government.
- **D:** D States the source-recorded proposition for State vs government.

Examiner trap: Do not identify State vs government by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic.

MCQ 9

Which thinker/concept-proposition pair is correctly matched?

- A. Internal vs external sovereignty - internal sovereignty means supremacy over persons and associations inside the territory; external sovereignty means.
- B. Legal vs political vs popular sovereignty - supreme legal authority of the state; the power to issue binding laws.
- C. Pluralism - sovereignty is a determinate human superior habitually obeyed and not habitually obedient to a like superior; this is the strongest legal-monist.
- D. Sovereignty vs power - people create a sovereign for order, peace and security; once created, sovereign authority is near-irrevocable because challenge risks.

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Source-exact: Internal vs external sovereignty is associated with this proposition.
- **B:** B Source disagrees: Legal vs political vs popular sovereignty is recorded with legal sovereignty is the formal law-making superior; political sovereignty is the effective power behind it; popular sovereignty places ultimate authority in the people (PDF pp.189-193).
- **C:** C Misplaced: Pluralism is recorded with the view that important associations in society embody values and claims not wholly created by the state, so the state cannot be treated as morally all-comprehensive (PDF pp.196-198).
- **D:** D Belongs elsewhere: Sovereignty vs power is recorded with Gauba resolves the federalism puzzle by distinguishing sovereignty, which remains single, from powers, which may be distributed among organs and levels of government (PDF pp.186-187).

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to Internal vs external sovereignty; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism.

MCQ 10

Which of the following pairs a name or concept with the proposition the source actually records for it?

- A. Bentham - the classical view from Bodin to Austin that sovereignty is one, supreme, indivisible and located in a definite person or body (PDF pp.194-195).
- B. De jure vs de facto sovereignty - de jure refers to legal title; de facto refers to actual effective control.
- C. Popular sovereignty - The effective power behind the legal sovereign; Dicey's "other sovereign" to which formal authority must bow (PDF pp.189-190).
- D. Locke - sovereignty is absolute and perpetual; the sovereign is source of law, though not freed from duty or moral responsibility altogether (PDF p.181).

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Source disagrees: Bentham is recorded with sovereignty is legally unbound but morally limited, and resistance may sometimes be justified if utility is violated (PDF p.183).
- **B:** B Matches the record: De jure vs de facto sovereignty is associated with this proposition.
- **C:** C Misplaced: Popular sovereignty is recorded with The people in corporate capacity are the source of authority; government is their agent, not the sovereign itself (PDF pp.182-193).
- **D:** D Cross-attached: Locke is recorded with people retain fundamental natural rights and remain supreme; ruler or government cannot be sovereign in the Hobbesian sense (PDF p.182).

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to De jure vs de facto sovereignty; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism.

MCQ 11

In which pair does the proposition genuinely belong to the label placed against it?

- A. Sovereignty - people create a sovereign for order, peace and security; once created, sovereign authority is near-irrevocable because challenge risks a return.
- B. Pluralism - internal sovereignty means supremacy over persons and associations inside the territory; external sovereignty means independence from foreign.
- C. Legal vs political vs popular sovereignty - legal sovereignty is the formal law-making superior; political sovereignty is the effective power behind it.
- D. Sovereignty vs power - sovereignty is a determinate human superior habitually obeyed and not habitually obedient to a like superior; this is the strongest.

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Misplaced: Sovereignty is recorded with supreme legal authority of the state; the power to issue binding laws, commands and decisions within jurisdiction, and to remain independent from external control (PDF pp.179-180).
- **B:** B Belongs elsewhere: Pluralism is recorded with the view that important associations in society embody values and claims not wholly created by the state, so the state cannot be treated as morally all-comprehensive (PDF pp.196-198).
- **C:** C Exact pair: Legal vs political vs popular sovereignty is associated with this proposition.
- **D:** D Cross-attached: Sovereignty vs power is recorded with Gauba resolves the federalism puzzle by distinguishing sovereignty, which remains single, from powers, which may be distributed among organs and levels of government (PDF pp.186-187).

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to Legal vs political vs popular sovereignty; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism.

MCQ 12

Only one pairing below reproduces the source's own association. Which is it?

- A. Sovereignty - internal sovereignty means supremacy over persons and associations inside the territory; external sovereignty means independence from foreign.
- B. Pluralism - sovereignty is a determinate human superior habitually obeyed and not habitually obedient to a like superior; this is the strongest legal-monist.
- C. Legal vs political vs popular sovereignty - people create a sovereign for order, peace and security; once created.
- D. Sovereignty vs power - Gauba resolves the federalism puzzle by distinguishing sovereignty, which remains single, from powers.

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Belongs elsewhere: Sovereignty is recorded with supreme legal authority of the state; the power to issue binding laws, commands and decisions within jurisdiction, and to remain independent from external control (PDF pp.179-180).
- **B:** B Cross-attached: Pluralism is recorded with the view that important associations in society embody values and claims not wholly created by the state, so the state cannot be treated as morally all-comprehensive (PDF pp.196-198).
- **C:** C Not this pair: Legal vs political vs popular sovereignty is recorded with legal sovereignty is the formal law-making superior; political sovereignty is the effective power behind it; popular sovereignty places ultimate authority in the people (PDF pp.189-193).
- **D:** D Exact pair: Sovereignty vs power is associated with this proposition.

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to Sovereignty vs power; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism.

MCQ 13

Identify the pair in which the recorded proposition matches its label exactly.

- A. State vs association - pluralists do not deny that the state has compulsory jurisdiction; they deny that this legal superiority automatically proves total.
- B. Rousseau - the classical view from Bodin to Austin that sovereignty is one, supreme, indivisible and located in a definite person or body (PDF pp.194-195).
- C. State vs government - about half a century after Bodin, Grotius extended sovereignty into the external/international sphere - independence of the sovereign.
- D. Bodin - people retain fundamental natural rights and remain supreme; ruler or government cannot be sovereign in the Hobbesian sense (PDF p.182).

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Kept where the source puts it: State vs association is associated with this proposition.
- **B:** B Mismatched: Rousseau is recorded with the people themselves are sovereign through the general will; government is only an agent and cannot logically claim sovereignty (PDF pp.182-193).
- **C:** C Not this pair: State vs government is recorded with sovereignty belongs to the state as an abstract continuing entity; governments are changing agents that exercise assigned powers (PDF pp.185-187, 202-203).
- **D:** D Wrong attachment: Bodin is recorded with sovereignty is absolute and perpetual; the sovereign is source of law, though not freed from duty or moral responsibility altogether (PDF p.181).

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to State vs association; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism.

MCQ 14

Which one of the following label-proposition pairings survives a strict source check?

- A. Rousseau - sovereignty belongs to the state as an abstract continuing entity; governments are changing agents that exercise assigned powers (PDF pp.185-187, 202-203).
- B. Bodin - sovereignty is absolute and perpetual; the sovereign is source of law, though not freed from duty or moral responsibility altogether (PDF p.181).
- C. Monistic sovereignty - people retain fundamental natural rights and remain supreme; ruler or government cannot be sovereign in the Hobbesian sense (PDF p.182).
- D. State vs association - de jure refers to legal title; de facto refers to actual effective control, especially in revolutionary situations (PDF pp.187-188).

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Mismatched: Rousseau is recorded with the people themselves are sovereign through the general will; government is only an agent and cannot logically claim sovereignty (PDF pp.182-193).
- **B:** B Source-exact: Bodin is associated with this proposition.
- **C:** C Not this pair: Monistic sovereignty is recorded with the classical view from Bodin to Austin that sovereignty is one, supreme, indivisible and located in a definite person or body (PDF pp.194-195).
- **D:** D Source disagrees: State vs association is recorded with pluralists do not deny that the state has compulsory jurisdiction; they deny that this legal superiority automatically proves total moral superiority.

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to Bodin; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism.

MCQ 15

Which pairing below would a careful source check leave standing?

- A. State vs government - sovereignty is a determinate human superior habitually obeyed and not habitually obedient to a like superior; this is the strongest.
- B. State vs association - the people themselves are sovereign through the general will; government is only an agent and cannot logically claim sovereignty (PDF).
- C. Grotius (Dutch jurist, "father of international law") - about half a century after Bodin, Grotius extended sovereignty into the external/international sphere.
- D. Hobbes - sovereignty is absolute and perpetual; the sovereign is source of law, though not freed from duty or moral responsibility altogether (PDF p.181).

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Not this pair: State vs government is recorded with sovereignty belongs to the state as an abstract continuing entity; governments are changing agents that exercise assigned powers (PDF pp.185-187, 202-203).
- **B:** B Source disagrees: State vs association is recorded with pluralists do not deny that the state has compulsory jurisdiction; they deny that this legal superiority automatically proves total moral superiority.
- **C:** C Source-exact: Grotius (Dutch jurist, "father of international law") is associated with this proposition.
- **D:** D Misplaced: Hobbes is recorded with people create a sovereign for order, peace and security; once created, sovereign authority is near-irrevocable because challenge risks a return to anarchy (PDF pp.182-183).

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to Grotius (Dutch jurist, "father of international law"); nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism.

MCQ 16

Which of these attributions is reproduced correctly rather than shifted to a neighbouring idea?

- A. Pluralism - legal sovereignty is the formal law-making superior; political sovereignty is the effective power behind it; popular sovereignty places ultimate.
- B. Austin - Gauba resolves the federalism puzzle by distinguishing sovereignty, which remains single, from powers.
- C. Sovereignty - about half a century after Bodin, Grotius extended sovereignty into the external/international sphere - independence of the sovereign state.
- D. Hobbes - people create a sovereign for order, peace and security; once created, sovereign authority is near-irrevocable because challenge risks a return to.

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Wrong attachment: Pluralism is recorded with the view that important associations in society embody values and claims not wholly created by the state, so the state cannot be treated as morally all-comprehensive (PDF pp.196-198).
- **B:** B Source disagrees: Austin is recorded with sovereignty is a determinate human superior habitually obeyed and not habitually obedient to a like superior; this is the strongest legal-monist formulation (PDF pp.183-185).
- **C:** C Misplaced: Sovereignty is recorded with supreme legal authority of the state; the power to issue binding laws, commands and decisions within jurisdiction, and to remain independent from external control (PDF pp.179-180).
- **D:** D Matches the record: Hobbes is associated with this proposition.

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to Hobbes; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism.

MCQ 17

Consider the following statements:

1. **Locke** is associated with: people retain fundamental natural rights and remain supreme; ruler or government cannot be sovereign in the Hobbesian sense (PDF p.182).
2. **Austin** is associated with: This maxim is not traceable to Gauba or to the Socio-Political Philosophy Kautilya synopsis used here; it is more reliably associated with Lord Palmerston. Treat any such attribution as unsafe and answer via the verified seven-limbed-state material instead (see Section 6).

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '1 only' is correct.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '2 only' is not the right combination.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is not the right combination.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is not the right combination.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with Locke does not validate the second pairing.

MCQ 18

Consider the following statements:

1. **Rousseau** is associated with: Alongside this three-front attack, Laski separately builds a moral argument: he distinguishes state from government (the state's powers are only ever exercised by fallible officials who "may deliberately exploit the authority they possess"), and argues that because society is itself "federal" (an association of associations), "authority must be federal also" - sovereignty should be coordinative and shared according to function, not hierarchical and omnipotent (PDF pp.201-203).
2. **Laski** is associated with: Alongside this three-front attack, Laski separately builds a moral argument: he distinguishes state from government (the state's powers are only ever exercised by fallible officials who "may deliberately exploit the authority they possess"), and argues that because society is itself "federal" (an association of associations), "authority must be federal also" - sovereignty should be coordinative and shared according to function, not hierarchical and omnipotent (PDF pp.201-203).

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '1 only' is not the right combination.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '2 only' is correct.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is not the right combination.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is not the right combination.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with Rousseau does not validate the second pairing.

MCQ 19

Consider the following statements:

1. **Bentham** is associated with: sovereignty is legally unbound but morally limited, and resistance may sometimes be justified if utility is violated (PDF p.183).
2. **MacIver** is associated with: MacIver concludes that the state should coordinate and resolve conflicts between associations rather than determine their purposes, because the "common interest" is never exhaustively represented by the state alone - the partial interests of many associations are also part of it (PDF pp.204-206).

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '1 only' is not the right combination.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '2 only' is not the right combination.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is correct.

- **D:** D Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is not the right combination.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with Bentham does not validate the second pairing.

MCQ 20

Consider the following statements:

1. **Austin** is associated with: the supplied Socio-Political Philosophy synopsis
2. **Kautilya (secondary-source comparator)** is associated with: The effective power behind the legal sovereign; Dicey's "other sovereign" to which formal authority must bow (PDF pp.189-190).

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '1 only' is not the right combination.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '2 only' is not the right combination.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is not the right combination.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is correct.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with Austin does not validate the second pairing.

MCQ 21

Consider the following statements:

1. **Laski** is associated with: Alongside this three-front attack, Laski separately builds a moral argument: he distinguishes state from government (the state's powers are only ever exercised by fallible officials who "may deliberately exploit the authority they possess"), and argues that because society is itself "federal" (an association of associations), "authority must be federal also" - sovereignty should be coordinative and shared according to function, not hierarchical and omnipotent (PDF pp.201-203).
2. **"Kautilya said states have no permanent friends or enemies."** is associated with: The people in corporate capacity are the source of authority; government is their agent, not the sovereign itself (PDF pp.182-193).

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '1 only' is correct.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '2 only' is not the right combination.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is not the right combination.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is not the right combination.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with Laski does not validate the second pairing.

MCQ 22

Consider the following statements:

1. **MacIver** is associated with: supreme legal authority of the state; the power to issue binding laws, commands and decisions within jurisdiction, and to remain independent from external control (PDF pp.179-180).
2. **Sovereignty** is associated with: supreme legal authority of the state; the power to issue binding laws, commands and decisions within jurisdiction, and to remain independent from external control (PDF pp.179-180).

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '1 only' is not the right combination.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '2 only' is correct.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is not the right combination.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is not the right combination.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with MacIver does not validate the second pairing.

MCQ 23

Consider the following statements:

1. **Kautilya (secondary-source comparator)** is associated with: the supplied Socio-Political Philosophy synopsis
2. **Legal sovereignty** is associated with: Definite, organized and sanction-backed authority recognized by law; closest to Austin's formulation (PDF pp.183-190).

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '1 only' is not the right combination.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '2 only' is not the right combination.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is correct.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is not the right combination.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with Kautilya (secondary-source comparator) does not validate the second pairing.

MCQ 24

Consider the following statements:

1. **"Kautilya said states have no permanent friends or enemies."** is associated with: The effective power behind the legal sovereign; Dicey's "other sovereign" to which formal authority must bow (PDF pp.189-190).
2. **Political sovereignty** is associated with: These five attributes should be read as the classical/Austinian doctrine taken together, not as isolated claims unique to one thinker - Bodin supplies "absolute and perpetual"; the fuller five-part list is Gauba's consolidated exposition of the same monist tradition.

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '1 only' is not the right combination.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '2 only' is not the right combination.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is not the right combination.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is correct.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with "Kautilya said states have no permanent friends or enemies." does not validate the second pairing.

MCQ 25 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **"Austin means the sovereign has no moral or social limits."**?

- A. Gauba explicitly says Austin's theory dwells on legal form and does not deny moral or social restraints in practice; it only denies a legally superior human.
- B. Sovereignty means supreme legal authority of the state; the power to issue binding laws, commands and decisions within jurisdiction.
- C. Rousseau treats government as agent of the general will; sovereignty remains with the people in their corporate capacity (PDF pp.182-183, 190-193).
- D. Legal sovereignty means Definite, organized and sanction-backed authority recognized by law; closest to Austin's formulation (PDF pp.183-190).

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Directly repairs the stated misconception: Gauba explicitly says Austin's theory dwells on legal form and does not deny moral or social restraints in practice; it only denies a legally superior human authority above the sovereign (PDF pp.184-185).
- **B:** B Repairs a different misconception, 'Sovereignty means the classical view from Bodin to Austin that sovereignty is one, supreme, indivisible and located in a definite person or body (PDF pp.194-195).', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **C:** C Repairs a different misconception, "'Rousseau's popular sovereignty means the elected government is sovereign.'", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **D:** D Repairs a different misconception, 'Legal sovereignty means These five attributes should be read as the classical/Austinian doctrine taken together, not as isolated claims unique to one thinker - Bodin supplies "absolute and perpetual"; the fuller five-part list is Gauba's consolidated exposition of the same monist tradition.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about "Austin means the sovereign has no moral or social, not a different error from the same topic.

MCQ 26 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **"Rousseau's popular sovereignty means the elected government is sovereign."**?

- A. Legal sovereignty means Definite, organized and sanction-backed authority recognized by law; closest to Austin's formulation (PDF pp.183-190).
- B. Rousseau treats government as agent of the general will; sovereignty remains with the people in their corporate capacity (PDF pp.182-183, 190-193).
- C. Pluralists limit and morally qualify the state; they do not abolish it, and they retain coordinating functions for it (PDF pp.197-198).
- D. Rousseau's general will is presented as the common or real interest, not the mere sum of momentary particular desires (PDF pp.191-193).

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Repairs a different misconception, 'Legal sovereignty means These five attributes should be read as the classical/Austinian doctrine taken together, not as isolated claims unique to one thinker - Bodin supplies "absolute and perpetual"; the fuller five-part list is Gauba's consolidated exposition of the same monist tradition.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **B:** B Directly repairs the stated misconception: Rousseau treats government as agent of the general will; sovereignty remains with the people in their corporate capacity (PDF pp.182-183, 190-193).
- **C:** C Repairs a different misconception, "Pluralists are anarchists.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **D:** D Repairs a different misconception, "Popular sovereignty is just majority whim.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about "Rousseau's popular sovereignty means the elected, not a different error from the same topic.

MCQ 27 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **"Federalism proves sovereignty is divided."**?

- A. Legal sovereignty means Definite, organized and sanction-backed authority recognized by law; closest to Austin's formulation (PDF pp.183-190).
- B. Pluralists limit and morally qualify the state; they do not abolish it, and they retain coordinating functions for it (PDF pp.197-198).
- C. Gauba distinguishes sovereignty from governmental powers; powers may be distributed while sovereignty remains one (PDF pp.186-187).
- D. Rousseau's general will is presented as the common or real interest, not the mere sum of momentary particular desires (PDF pp.191-193).

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Repairs a different misconception, 'Legal sovereignty means These five attributes should be read as the classical/Austinian doctrine taken together, not as isolated claims unique to one thinker - Bodin supplies "absolute and perpetual"; the fuller five-part list is Gauba's consolidated exposition of the same monist tradition.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **B:** B Repairs a different misconception, "Pluralists are anarchists.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.

- **C:** C Directly repairs the stated misconception: Gauba distinguishes sovereignty from governmental powers; powers may be distributed while sovereignty remains one (PDF pp.186-187).
- **D:** D Repairs a different misconception, "Popular sovereignty is just majority whim.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about "Federalism proves sovereignty is divided.", not a different error from the same topic.

MCQ 28 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **"Pluralists are anarchists."**?

- A. Rousseau's general will is presented as the common or real interest, not the mere sum of momentary particular desires (PDF pp.191-193).
- B. Legal sovereignty means Definite, organized and sanction-backed authority recognized by law; closest to Austin's formulation (PDF pp.183-190).
- C. Gauba distinguishes sovereignty from governmental powers; powers may be distributed while sovereignty remains one (PDF pp.186-187).
- D. Pluralists limit and morally qualify the state; they do not abolish it, and they retain coordinating functions for it (PDF pp.197-198).

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Repairs a different misconception, "Popular sovereignty is just majority whim.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **B:** B Repairs a different misconception, 'Legal sovereignty means These five attributes should be read as the classical/Austinian doctrine taken together, not as isolated claims unique to one thinker - Bodin supplies "absolute and perpetual"; the fuller five-part list is Gauba's consolidated exposition of the same monist tradition.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **C:** C Repairs a different misconception, "Federalism proves sovereignty is divided.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **D:** D Directly repairs the stated misconception: Pluralists limit and morally qualify the state; they do not abolish it, and they retain coordinating functions for it (PDF pp.197-198).

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about "Pluralists are anarchists.", not a different error from the same topic.

MCQ 29 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **"Popular sovereignty is just majority whim."**?

- A. Rousseau's general will is presented as the common or real interest, not the mere sum of momentary particular desires (PDF pp.191-193).
- B. Pluralists limit and morally qualify the state; they do not abolish it, and they retain coordinating functions for it (PDF pp.197-198).
- C. Gauba distinguishes sovereignty from governmental powers; powers may be distributed while sovereignty remains one (PDF pp.186-187).
- D. Legal sovereignty means Definite, organized and sanction-backed authority recognized by law; closest to Austin's formulation (PDF pp.183-190).

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Directly repairs the stated misconception: Rousseau's general will is presented as the common or real interest, not the mere sum of momentary particular desires (PDF pp.191-193).

- **B:** B Repairs a different misconception, "Pluralists are anarchists.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **C:** C Repairs a different misconception, "Federalism proves sovereignty is divided.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **D:** D Repairs a different misconception, 'Legal sovereignty means These five attributes should be read as the classical/Austinian doctrine taken together, not as isolated claims unique to one thinker - Bodin supplies "absolute and perpetual"; the fuller five-part list is Gauba's consolidated exposition of the same monist tradition.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about "Popular sovereignty is just majority whim.", not a different error from the same topic.

MCQ 30 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **"Kautilya and Austin give the same theory because both emphasize a ruler."**?

- A. Pluralists limit and morally qualify.
- B. Kautilya's
- C. Gauba distinguishes sovereignty from.
- D. Rousseau's general will is presented.

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Repairs a different misconception, "Pluralists are anarchists.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **B:** B Directly repairs the stated misconception: Kautilya's.
- **C:** C Repairs a different misconception, "Federalism proves sovereignty is divided.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **D:** D Repairs a different misconception, "Popular sovereignty is just majority whim.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about "Kautilya and Austin give the same theory because, not a different error from the same topic.

MCQ 31 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **Sovereignty means the classical view from Bodin to Austin that sovereignty is one, supreme, indivisible and located in a definite person or body (PDF pp.194-195).?**

- A. Gauba explicitly says Austin's theory dwells on legal form and does not deny moral or social restraints in practice; it only denies a legally superior human.
- B. Rousseau treats government as agent of the general will; sovereignty remains with the people in their corporate capacity (PDF pp.182-183, 190-193).
- C. Sovereignty means supreme legal authority of the state; the power to issue binding laws, commands and decisions within jurisdiction.
- D. Legal sovereignty means Definite, organized and sanction-backed authority recognized by law; closest to Austin's formulation (PDF pp.183-190).

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Repairs a different misconception, "Austin means the sovereign has no moral or social limits.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **B:** B Repairs a different misconception, "Rousseau's popular sovereignty means the elected government is sovereign.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.

- **C:** C Directly repairs the stated misconception: Sovereignty means supreme legal authority of the state; the power to issue binding laws, commands and decisions within jurisdiction, and to remain independent from external control (PDF pp.179-180).
- **D:** D Repairs a different misconception, 'Legal sovereignty means These five attributes should be read as the classical/Austinian doctrine taken together, not as isolated claims unique to one thinker - Bodin supplies "absolute and perpetual"; the fuller five-part list is Gauba's consolidated exposition of the same monist tradition.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about Sovereignty means the classical view from Bodin to, not a different error from the same topic.

MCQ 32 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **Legal sovereignty means These five attributes should be read as the classical/Austinian doctrine taken together, not as isolated claims unique to one thinker - Bodin supplies "absolute and perpetual"; the fuller five-part list is Gauba's consolidated exposition of the same monist tradition.?**

- A. Rousseau's general will is presented as the common or real interest, not the mere sum of momentary particular desires (PDF pp.191-193).
- B. Rousseau treats government as agent of the general will; sovereignty remains with the people in their corporate capacity (PDF pp.182-183, 190-193).
- C. Pluralists limit and morally qualify the state; they do not abolish it, and they retain coordinating functions for it (PDF pp.197-198).
- D. Legal sovereignty means Definite, organized and sanction-backed authority recognized by law; closest to Austin's formulation (PDF pp.183-190).

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Repairs a different misconception, "Popular sovereignty is just majority whim.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **B:** B Repairs a different misconception, "Rousseau's popular sovereignty means the elected government is sovereign.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **C:** C Repairs a different misconception, "Pluralists are anarchists.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **D:** D Directly repairs the stated misconception: Legal sovereignty means Definite, organized and sanction-backed authority recognized by law; closest to Austin's formulation (PDF pp.183-190).

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about Legal sovereignty means These five attributes should, not a different error from the same topic.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

VERIFIED UPSC PRELIMS / GS MAINS PYQ STATUS

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ORIGINAL GS MAINS PRACTICE WITH MODEL SOLUTIONS

Original GS Mains Model 1 - 10 marks

Question: What is sovereignty, and why must legal, political and popular sovereignty be distinguished? Answer in 150 words.

Demand decode: the directive what requires the answer to fix the definition first and then show what follows from it. Fix the boundary of is sovereignty, and why must legal, political and popular sovereignty be distinguished in the opening line, carry the argument on Introduction, Sovereignty, Core and Legal, and reserve the closing sentences for the qualification that popular sovereignty is the normative doctrine that the people in their corporate capacity are the ultimate source of legitimate authority and that government remains their agent.

Model answer (150 words):

Introduction: Sovereignty denotes final public authority, but legal, political and popular sovereignty identify different locations and dimensions of that authority. Core analysis: Legal sovereignty is the determinate, law-recognised organ whose enactments count as binding. Political sovereignty is the effective power to which formal lawmakers must respond, such as an electorate, party organisation or organised public opinion. Popular sovereignty is the normative doctrine that the people in their corporate capacity are the ultimate source of legitimate authority and that government remains their agent. A parliament may therefore be legally supreme while politically constrained and democratically derivative. Critical evaluation: The distinctions prevent legal validity, social influence and legitimacy from being collapsed. Constitutional democracy connects them through authorised institutions, elections, rights and public accountability, even though their alignment is never perfect. Conclusion: Sovereignty is intelligible only when final legal competence, effective political influence and the people's legitimating authorship are distinguished and constitutionally connected.

Why this earns marks: it obeys what instead of drifting into description, attaches each claim to named evidence (Introduction, Sovereignty, Core and Legal), converts that evidence into analysis of is sovereignty, and why must legal, political and popular sovereignty be distinguished, and keeps the examiner-facing qualification that popular sovereignty is the normative doctrine that the people in their corporate capacity are the ultimate source of legitimate authority and that government remains their agent. At 150 words it stays inside the 150-word GS ceiling for 10 marks.

Original GS Mains Model 2 - 10 marks

Question: Reconstruct Bodin's case for absolute, perpetual and undivided sovereignty. Answer in 150 words.

Demand decode: the directive discuss requires the answer to open the competing dimensions and adjudicate between them instead of listing them. Fix the boundary of bodin's case for absolute, perpetual and undivided sovereignty in the opening line, carry the argument on Introduction, Bodin, Core and Sovereignty, and reserve the closing sentences for the qualification that conclusion: Bodin's doctrine secures the legal unity and continuity of the commonwealth, but its morally stated limits require institutional form if finality is not to become arbitrary power.

Model answer (130 words):

Introduction: Bodin developed sovereignty to identify a continuing and final source of law capable of holding a conflict-ridden commonwealth together. Core analysis: Sovereignty is absolute because no rival human authority within the polity can legally overrule it; perpetual because it belongs to the continuing commonwealth rather than a temporary magistrate; and indivisible because two independent final law-makers would make authoritative settlement impossible. The sovereign legislates, declares war and peace, appoints officers and judges in the last instance. These attributes distinguish sovereignty from delegated powers exercised for a term or under another's authorization. Yet unenforceable moral limits may not adequately restrain final power. Conclusion: Bodin's doctrine secures the legal unity and continuity of the commonwealth, but its morally stated limits require institutional form if finality is not to become arbitrary power.

Why this earns marks: it obeys discuss instead of drifting into description, attaches each claim to named evidence (Introduction, Bodin, Core and Sovereignty), converts that evidence into analysis of bodin's case for absolute, perpetual and undivided sovereignty, and keeps the examiner-facing qualification that conclusion: Bodin's doctrine secures the legal unity and continuity of the commonwealth, but its morally stated limits require institutional form if finality is not to become arbitrary power. At 130 words it stays inside the 150-word GS ceiling for 10 marks.

Original GS Mains Model 3 - 10 marks

Question: Critically examine Austin's command theory of sovereignty. Answer in 150 words.

Demand decode: the directive critically examine requires the answer to test the proposition against its strongest objection before giving a verdict. Fix the boundary of examine Austin's command theory of sovereignty in the opening line, carry the argument on Introduction, Austin, Core and Law, and reserve the closing sentences for the qualification that conclusion: Austin remains a sharp account of legal finality, but constitutional rules, institutional continuity and plural social authority prevent it from becoming a complete theory of the modern state.

Model answer (136 words):

Introduction: Austin gives the classical legal-monist thesis its most precise form by locating positive law in commands issued by a determinate human superior. Core analysis: The sovereign receives habitual obedience from the bulk of society and is not habitually obedient to a like superior. Law is the sovereign's general command backed by sanction, providing a clear criterion for distinguishing positive law from morality. The theory illuminates legal hierarchy and the need for ultimate settlement where commands conflict. It also avoids disguising moral approval as a condition of legal existence. Austin remains useful as an account of legal finality, not a complete sociology or ethics of political obligation. Conclusion: Austin remains a sharp account of legal finality, but constitutional rules, institutional continuity and plural social authority prevent it from becoming a complete theory of the modern state.

Why this earns marks: it obeys critically examine instead of drifting into description, attaches each claim to named evidence (Introduction, Austin, Core and Law), converts that evidence into analysis of examine Austin's command theory of sovereignty, and keeps the examiner-facing qualification that conclusion: Austin remains a sharp account of legal finality, but constitutional rules, institutional continuity and plural social authority prevent it from becoming a complete theory of the modern state. At 136 words it stays inside the 150-word GS ceiling for 10 marks.

Original GS Mains Model 4 - 15 marks

Question: Why did Laski reject absolute sovereignty, and does pluralism preserve political order? Answer in 250 words.

Demand decode: the directive why requires the answer to give the grounds, not only the description, and rank them. Fix the boundary of did Laski reject absolute sovereignty, and does pluralism preserve political order in the opening line, carry the argument on Introduction, Laski, Core and Historically, and reserve the closing sentences for the qualification that pluralism preserves order only if the state retains residual coordination, protects individuals against internal group domination and secures common goods without claiming moral omnipotence.

Model answer (229 words):

Introduction: Laski rejects absolute sovereignty because legal supremacy does not establish unlimited effective power, exclusive social value or unconditional moral obligation. Core analysis: Historically, custom and inherited institutions constrain rulers; internationally, interdependence and law limit unilateral action; morally, citizens owe loyalty to purposes and associations not created by the state. Family, church, union and professional body possess genuine authority within their spheres. The state cannot claim that every valid social end derives from its will, nor can law alone settle whether obedience is justified. Pluralism thus replaces a command pyramid with multiple centres of social loyalty. Further development: The strongest pluralist position is functional rather than territorial anarchy. Different associations possess authority because they pursue distinctive goods and organise real practices, but none automatically receives immunity from common law. Public authority remains responsible for resolving external conflicts, guaranteeing exit and protecting members whose group is itself oppressive. This reply preserves plural loyalty without romanticising every association. It also explains why Laski's critique is directed against unlimited supremacy, not against every form of state coordination. Critical evaluation: Fragmentation remains a serious objection. Pluralism preserves order only if the state retains residual coordination, protects individuals against internal group domination and secures common goods without claiming moral omnipotence. Conclusion: Laski's pluralism preserves order only when denial of moral omnipotence is joined to a rights-bound state with residual responsibility for coordination and adjudication.

Why this earns marks: it obeys why instead of drifting into description, attaches each claim to named evidence (Introduction, Laski, Core and Historically), converts that evidence into analysis of did Laski reject absolute sovereignty, and does pluralism preserve political order, and keeps the examiner-facing qualification that pluralism

preserves order only if the state retains residual coordination, protects individuals against internal group domination and secures common goods without claiming moral omnipotence. At 229 words it stays inside the 250-word GS ceiling for 15 marks.

Original GS Mains Model 5 - 15 marks

Question: Can sovereignty remain one while governmental powers are divided in a federation? Answer in 250 words.

Demand decode: the directive can requires the answer to state the conditions under which the claim holds and where they fail. Fix the boundary of sovereignty remain one while governmental powers are divided in a federation in the opening line, carry the argument on Introduction, Federalism, Core and Classical, and reserve the closing sentences for the qualification that yet calling every powerful unit sovereign obscures the common framework that makes federal claims enforceable.

Model answer (233 words):

Introduction: Federalism divides constitutionally assigned powers, but that need not imply several independent sovereigns within one legal order. Core analysis: A constitution allocates legislative, executive and fiscal competences between central and regional governments and creates adjudicative mechanisms for boundary disputes. Classical theory can describe sovereignty as belonging to the continuing constitutional state or constituent people while governments exercise limited powers under it. This separates the ultimate validity of the constitutional order from the many authorised centres that govern within their fields. Shared rule and self-rule alter how authority is exercised without necessarily multiplying final legal systems. Further development: The Indian case can be used cautiously as an institutional illustration rather than proof of one metaphysical theory. The GST Council joins Union and State governments in continuing fiscal coordination under a common constitutional framework. Its bargaining and shared decision processes show that public power can be dispersed, negotiated and mutually dependent. They do not by themselves settle where constituent sovereignty lies. Federal practice therefore supports a distinction between one legal order, several constitutionally protected governments and multiple centres of political influence. Critical evaluation: The distinction becomes formalistic if it ignores political bargaining, asymmetric autonomy or practical incapacity. Yet calling every powerful unit sovereign obscures the common framework that makes federal claims enforceable. Conclusion: Federalism divides and checks the exercise of public power without necessarily multiplying the ultimate constitutional orders from which those powers derive.

Why this earns marks: it obeys can instead of drifting into description, attaches each claim to named evidence (Introduction, Federalism, Core and Classical), converts that evidence into analysis of sovereignty remain one while governmental powers are divided in a federation, and keeps the examiner-facing qualification that yet calling every powerful unit sovereign obscures the common framework that makes federal claims enforceable. At 233 words it stays inside the 250-word GS ceiling for 15 marks.

Original GS Mains Model 6 - 15 marks

Question: Distinguish internal from external sovereignty in an age of international interdependence. Answer in 250 words.

Demand decode: the directive distinguish requires the answer to fix each side of the distinction precisely and show where it does the analytical work. Fix the boundary of internal from external sovereignty in an age of international interdependence in the opening line, carry the argument on Introduction, Internal, Core and Internally, and reserve the closing sentences for the qualification that unequal bargaining and coercive dependency can erode meaningful autonomy even where juridical equality remains.

Model answer (233 words):

Introduction: Internal sovereignty concerns final authority within a territory, while external sovereignty concerns independence from foreign control and juridical equality among states. Core analysis: Internally, the state claims compulsory jurisdiction over persons and associations and resolves conflicts through law. Externally, it enters relations without being legally subordinate to another state. Treaties, international organisations, markets and security commitments constrain choices, but a voluntarily accepted rule is not identical to colonial subjection. Interdependence can enlarge effective capacity by allowing states to achieve common goals through cooperation. Formal independence and practical autonomy must therefore be separated. Further development: Three layers prevent an all-or-nothing conclusion. Juridical sovereignty concerns recognition and legal equality; empirical sovereignty

concerns administrative and economic capacity; democratic sovereignty concerns whether binding commitments are authorised and contestable. A formally independent but heavily dependent state may possess the first while lacking the second, and a powerful state may possess capacity while evading democratic control. Treaties can pool capacity without destroying status when commitments are reciprocal, transparent and revisable. Interdependence therefore transforms the exercise and effectiveness of sovereignty more clearly than its formal existence. Critical evaluation: The classical language of unrestricted independence is misleading, yet sovereignty has not disappeared. Unequal bargaining and coercive dependency can erode meaningful autonomy even where juridical equality remains. Conclusion: Contemporary sovereignty combines internal constitutional authority and external equal status with negotiated obligations, while remaining alert to coercive dependence that empties formal freedom.

Why this earns marks: it obeys distinguish instead of drifting into description, attaches each claim to named evidence (Introduction, Internal, Core and Internally), converts that evidence into analysis of internal from external sovereignty in an age of international interdependence, and keeps the examiner-facing qualification that unequal bargaining and coercive dependency can erode meaningful autonomy even where juridical equality remains. At 233 words it stays inside the 250-word GS ceiling for 15 marks.
